

Hatching & Texture Marks

Building tone with line

Hatching is the technique of using parallel lines to suggest tone and shadow. It's one of the oldest mark-making traditions in drawing and a foundational skill for pencil, pen, and ink work.

KEY CONCEPTS

Types of Hatching

Hatching: parallel lines in one direction. Cross-hatching: two or more layers of hatching at different angles. Contour hatching: lines that follow the form of the object. Scribble/random hatching: loose marks for texture.

Building Value

The closer the lines are spaced, the darker the tone appears. Start with widely spaced lines and add layers. Never try to get dark values in one pass — build up gradually. Consistent line weight makes cleaner-looking hatching.

Directional Hatching

The direction of your hatching lines communicates form. Lines that follow the surface of a sphere will read differently than flat vertical lines — the former suggests roundness, the latter suggests flatness. Use direction intentionally.

Pen vs Pencil

Ink hatching must commit to each line — no erasing. Pencil allows correction but requires more care not to smudge. Pen hatching is typically crisper and higher contrast; pencil hatching is softer and more blendable.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Create a 5-step value scale using only parallel hatching (white → black).
2. Draw a sphere using contour hatching — lines that wrap around the form.
3. Fill a page with cross-hatching experiments: vary spacing, angle, and layers.

FURTHER READING

■ Proko – Hatching Techniques

<https://youtu.be/OcJPNMFFKHs>

■ New Masters – Mark Making

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b_w_hdwaIV8